Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · GROW · Spring 2 Week 3 · Monday 8 March 2027 · P6

Lesson

Devise a story about a new plan

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Devise a short performance about overcoming change.

Today I can

I can help order four story beats.

I can contribute a performance choice.

I can record my choice and a next step.

Prepare

For up to five pupils: books or arts logs and pencils.

Clear personal spaces or seats for hand-gesture performance. All props and spaces in the story are imagined.

Read the two fictional performance cards aloud. Use an adult-written four-beat outline if needed.

No device, instrument, costume, scenery or external performance is needed. Retain the first outline and individual logs for the next lesson.

Cover route

Read the smaller-space story and both fictional comparison cards. Model plan, change, choice and result with safe hand movements. Pupils devise a short scene using accessible roles and original words or silent movement. Compare two trials and keep a four-beat outline, observation and individual arts-log contributions. Keep this attempt for the next lesson.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: We will devise a short scene about a group that changes its plan. Agree a calm open-hand stop cue. Choose an acting, voice or directing role that fits you. No contact, running or loud sound is needed.

Look for: Each pupil confirms a role and access route. Adult checks safe space and the stop cue.

Fallback: Offer a silent director role: the pupil chooses the cue or pose and an adult performs it.

Check and response: A creative contribution can be a deliberate cue, a pose or a choice of order; it does not require public speech.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: This is a made-up story called A smaller show space. Nothing really blocks our room. What is the change? Which choice helps the group respond? We will show a manageable change, not act out personal distress.

Look for: Pupils separate the changed space from the group's response of pausing, asking and adapting.

Fallback: Use two prompts: What got smaller? What did they change? Offer hands wide then close as a visual cue.

Check and response: The space got smaller. The group changed wide moves into small moves after asking for ideas. They did not need to force the old plan to work.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: Read or demonstrate both fictional comparison cards with calm hand movements. In one example I say, What could we try? In the other, I pause, invite a small hand move and repeat it. Which feature shows the group choosing a new plan? Check: does a wide first pose belong before or after the small-space cue?

Look for: Pupil identifies four beats and compares narration with pause, invitation or repetition. Adult checks the story order before independent work.

Fallback: Read one card and show only two contrasting hand shapes. Ask the pupil to place the change before the new move.

Check and response: The wide first pose goes before the small-space cue. Repeating a chosen small move can make the group's decision visible without words.

We do 6 minutes

Say: Each person offers one small idea or chooses one offered by a peer. With up to five pupils, use mover, narrator, director or cue roles; roles may be shared. Test a short four-beat version. Does the audience see what changed and what the group chose to do?

Look for: Group creates a workable four-beat outline with agreed accessible roles and a clear response to change.

Fallback: Keep the supplied story and offer two choices at the choice beat: ask a helper or test a small move. Pupil selects and directs it.

Check and response: A clear choice could be a narrator question followed by small moves, or a silent pause followed by offered hand moves and an agreed repeated one.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: Use three minutes for roles and the outline, five for two calm trials, two to decide what to keep, and four to log each person's contribution. Use the supplied story or a similar invented low-stakes change. If sound is chosen, use quiet original words or hand taps below speaking volume. Stop on the agreed cue.

Look for: Real scene or directed scene has a clear change, response and result. Each pupil identifies an actual creative contribution and a trial.

Fallback: Use seated hand gestures and adult narration for the four beats. Pupil directs one beat and confirms the outline and reason.

Check and response: Example only: I chose a pause before the small move so the audience could see the character thinking. Our group tested narration and silence, then kept the narrator.

Review 5 minutes

Say: Give descriptive feedback using I noticed ... . The maker can correct the audience's reading. Agree one next step linked to clarity rather than confidence. Use the last two minutes to store outlines, clear the space and settle.

Look for: Audience reads the change and response. Maker records a specific next step while retaining the first attempt.

Fallback: Adult watches privately and reads back a short exact observation for pupil confirmation.

Check and response: Useful feedback: I saw the space shrink, but the new plan was rushed. Next step: hold the chosen small move before the final pose.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Keep your own words and the support used. An adult may write and read them back. Mark a trial as a trial. Do not copy a model reflection or claim another pupil's decision.

Look for: Dated individual reflection explains an actual choice, trial and next step.

Fallback: Pupil points to a beat and confirms a choice; adult records the observed action and confirmed words.

Check: Example only: I directed the pause at the choice beat. We kept a silent hand cue because it helped us start together. Next time I will make the final pose clearer.

Evidence and review

Retain a dated sequence sketch or cue record, a brief adult observation of the real performance or rehearsal, and each pupil's own confirmed arts-log words. Record the contribution, change and support actually used. A photograph or recording is optional under local consent procedures. Never enter a teacher model as pupil work.

Misconceptions

Overcoming change means the character feels happy at once - A pause, a request for help or a workable new plan can show a response. The ending need not remove every feeling.

More speech makes the story clearer - A still pose, silent cue or repeated move may make a choice clearer.

The audience must guess the exact intended feeling - Ask what the audience saw, then let the maker explain their intention. More than one reading is possible.

Questions

foundation: Which part comes first?

middle: Which cue helps the next part start?

higher: How does the last pose show the new plan has worked?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Check a clear personal space before any movement. Walk only; no running, lifting, falling, climbing, throwing or actual building. Keep all imagined props imaginary. Use an agreed open-hand stop cue. Do not move another pupil or their chair.

Emotional and sensory access

Use invented situations. No personal accounts, surprise noise, touch, contact, shouting or forced eye contact. Offer seated movement, silent gesture, narrator or director roles. Pupils may share with a trusted adult only. Agree a calm place and a return cue before starting.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Show one story beat at a time. Rehearse three or four beats with concrete cue words. Model the first pose, then fade the adult lead. Check the pupil can point to the next beat.

Communication And Interaction: Offer pointing, signing, a narrator line, directing or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ... because ... and First ... next ... last ... .

Semh: Keep the event fictional and low stakes. Agree roles with pupils. Allow a pause, role change or private audience. Praise a specific contribution rather than confidence or compliance.

Sensory And Physical: Perform from a chair, use hands only or direct an adult. Avoid unexpected sound and touch. Ensure personal space. A silent cue is valid.

Eal: Plan in any language. Pair story cues with gestures. Accept oral rehearsal or a labelled sketch. Check the intended story order rather than accent or spelling.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. Each lesson is complete without the optional GROW next level stretch. Keep records for the award; these lessons alone do not complete or certify it.

Resilience can include pausing, asking for help, changing a plan and trying a manageable next step. It does not mean hiding feelings, tolerating harm or continuing through pain.

Optional next level stretch

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Task

Compare the two fictional examples. Choose a skill for your own role, such as cue timing or clear narration. Describe a starting point, practise once and note what changes.

Evidence

Keep the comparison, personal skill goal, first trial and a dated reflection in your arts log. Use your own words or confirmed dictated words.

Optional scope

This may support later next level review. It is optional and does not change today's Explore success criteria or complete the award.

Support

Pupil makes a feature-based comparison and links a chosen skill to an observed change in their own role.

Adult records the pupil's comparison and watches a short directed trial. The pupil confirms what changed.